

CONTROLLED UNCLASSIFIED INFORMATION

Justification and Approval (J&A) for Other Than Full and Open Competition

Was a J&A approved for the preceding acquisition where that acquisition required a J&A? ☒ Yes ☐ No

!! Attach the preceding J&A in the staff package for this J&A. The preceding J&A will be used as a reference document.

Is this a new or amended J&A Document? ☒ New ☐ Amended (Prior to Award Only!)

Is this a Bridge Action as defined at DAFFARS 5302.101? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Dollar Value of this Acquisition: [REDACTED]

Contracting Activity: AFSC/PK/PZIEC

Purchase Request (if available) / Local ID Number:

Program / Project (and PE, if applicable): Global Procedure Designer (GPD)

Program Type (PEO, Enterprise, of Operational): Other Contracting

Authority:

6.302-1 – 10 USC 3204(a)(1), Only One Responsible Source - No Other Supplies or Services Will Satisfy Agency Requirements

Estimated Contract Cost (including options): [REDACTED] J&A Type: ☐ Class ☒ Individual

COORDINATION (DAFFARS 5306.304(a))

[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]

[REDACTED] | [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]
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I. Agency and Contracting Activity.

United States Air Force
AFSC/PZIEC (Enterprise)
Tinker AFB, OK 73145
PURCHASE REQUEST: TBD

II. Nature and/or description of the action being approved.

An Individual Justification and Approval (J&A) is appropriate due to the presence of unpriced options and the inclusion of FAR 52.217-8, Option to Extend Services. If the option is exercised, it will be for the same work in the basic contract and will therefore be in-scope work. Furthermore, an individual J&A is appropriate based on the expectation that there will be multiple task orders (TOs) generated from the basic contract for work considered in-scope of the basic contract.

This J&A authorizes use of other than full and open competition procedures to procure a new 'commercial' contract for the engineering and technical support for Global Procedures Designer (GPD) software from MDA Systems, Ltd. (MDA) (CAGE: L9072), 13800 Commerce Parkway, Richmond, BC, Canada, V6V 2J3 through Canadian Commercial Corporation, 50 O'Connor St. Suite 1100, Ottawa, ON, Canada, K1A 0S6 for the Headquarters Air Force Flight Standards Agency (HQ AFFSA). This acquisition will accomplish second-tier engineering and continuing software development support for GPD software used by the United States Department of Defense (DoD) procedure design specialists to develop runway approaches and departures for Army, Air Force, and Navy airports; as well as other locations around the world.

This is not a Bridge Action. Acquisition is a follow-on contract. The current contract, FA8136-21-D-0001, was awarded 22 December 2020 with a Period of Performance (PoP) ending 31 March 2026 to MDA Systems, Ltd. (MDA) (CAGE: L9072) through Canadian Commercial Corporation for HQ AFFSA. The maximum government obligation of current contract, FA8136-21-D-0001, is [REDACTED]. FA8136-21-D-0001 is a commercial contract.

Acquisition is to be a Firm-Fixed Price (FFP) Indefinite Delivery/Indefinite Quantity (IDIQ) contract. Contract ceiling max is [REDACTED]

Ordering Period is one 5-year base with potential for 6-month extension under FAR 52.217-8. PoP will be established on each individual order issued hereunder.

Estimated Award date is April 2026.

III. Description of supplies/services required to meet agency needs.

Details of services required to meet agency needs are as shown:

CLIN X001 - Second Tier Engineering Technical Support: provide engineering and technical support services to review, investigate, and respond to GPD related issues reported by DoD users of the software. Service will include disposition of defects, provide resources to investigate and diagnose issues resulting in software fix actions or alternative methods to overcome identified issues. This CLIN will provide technical support and guidance in support of the United States Air Force (USAF) procedure design training requirements to include development of training and training products.

CLIN X002 - Hosting and Maintenance of HQ AFFSA Help-Desk Web-Based Software: provide hosting and maintenance service to the HQ AFFSA Technical Support web-based software tool, iSupport, while ensuring 24-hour availability to all USAF Instrument Procedure Designers at Continental United States (CONUS) and Outside Continental United States (OCONUS) overseas procedure design offices. Provide and maintain all necessary server hardware and software. Restore services within 24 hours in the event of an outage. Establish and ongoing maintenance agreement with iSupport Software ensuring the HQ AFFSA Technical Support Administrator retains accessibility to iSupport Technical Support. Ensure iSupport software and software products required by the iSupport tool remain current.

CLIN X003 - Software Engineering Support: provide engineering and software support services necessary to design, develop,

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test, install, and provide training for major software revisions, or of those changes that result in a software version change.

CLIN X004 - Software Engineering Patches: provide engineering and software support services necessary to design, develop, test, and install software patches, or of those changes that do not result in a software version change.

CLIN X005 - Travel: Contractor travel to attend working group meetings, conferences, on-site technical support and other meetings as required.

Contract Summary:

CLIN	Quantity	U/I	Unit Price	Estimated Dollars	Estimated Ordering Period
0001	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2026 - 31 March 2027
0002	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2026 - 31 March 2027
0003	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2026 - 31 March 2027
0004	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2026 - 31 March 2027
0005	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2026 - 31 March 2027
Base Ordering Period - Year I Estimated Value:					[REDACTED]
1001	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2027 - 31 March 2028
1002	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2027 - 31 March 2028
1003	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2027 - 31 March 2028
1004	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2027 - 31 March 2028
1005	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2027 - 31 March 2028
Base Ordering Period - Year II Estimated Value:					[REDACTED]
2001	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2028 - 31 March 2029
2002	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2028 - 31 March 2029
2003	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2028 - 31 March 2029
2004	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2028 - 31 March 2029
2005	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2028 - 31 March 2029
Base Ordering Period - Year III Estimated Value:					[REDACTED]
3001	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2029 - 31 March 2030
3002	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2029 - 31 March 2030
3003	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2029 - 31 March 2030
3004	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2029 - 31 March 2030
3005	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2029 - 31 March 2030
Base Ordering Period - Year IV Estimated Value:					[REDACTED]
4001	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2030 - 31 March 2031
4002	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2030 - 31 March 2031
4003	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2030 - 31 March 2031
4004	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2030 - 31 March 2031
4005	12	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2030 - 31 March 2031
Base Ordering Period - Year V Estimated Value:					[REDACTED]
5001	6	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2031 - 30 September 2031
5002	6	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2031 - 30 September 2031
5003	6	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2031 - 30 September 2031
5004	6	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2031 - 30 September 2031
5005	6	MO	[REDACTED]	[REDACTED]	01 April 2031 - 30 September 2031
Estimated 6-Month Option to Extend:					[REDACTED]

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Estimated Total Contract Value: [REDACTED]

For this IDIQ contract, the min/max and estimated quantity is as follows:

MINIMUM AMOUNT:

[REDACTED]

MAXIMUM AMOUNT:

[REDACTED]

Contract ceiling max value of [REDACTED] is for requirements unable to be projected.

Fund Appropriation for this contract is Operations and Maintenance (O&M) - 3400.

Unit prices for this acquisition were derived from known Contractor Labor Categories and estimated 2020, 2021, and 2022 along with 3% inflation. MDA was contacted September 2025 to provide their most current rates for comparison. Unit prices reflect similar comparison.

CLIN structure will not include separately priced CLINS for Intellectual Property (IP) or IP Rights. GPD is developed and owned by MDA Systems, Ltd. This follow-on commercial services contract is for DoD custom configurations, modifications, engineering support, and help-desk support.

This J&A covers all contract actions including options, TOs for all CLINs detailed in the CLIN table above.

IV. Demonstration that the contractor's unique qualifications or the nature of the acquisition requires use of the authority cited above.

Global Procedure Designer (GPD) is the software solution that supports instrument approach and departure procedure capability to all United States Air Force (USAF), Navy (USN), Army (USA) and Marine Corps (USMC). GPD evaluates airports and surrounding environment and determines the safest flight path and lowest altitudes aircraft can safely fly as they transition from terminal area flight operations to/from enroute phases of flight. GPD also supports Air Traffic Control (ATC) by developing ATC charts required to vector aircraft at locations where the DoD has radar approach control responsibilities.

Encompassed in this effort are operations support, technical support, software sustainment engineering, commercial off-the-shelf (COTS) software licensing, system verification and system testing and training. The GPD contractor will be required to, and has since 2002, accomplish these tasks in accordance the Performance Work Statement (PWS), terms and conditions of the contract and its attachments. The services for this contract are to provide labor, materials, transportation and other incidentals necessary to successfully sustain the product via defining, designing, developing, testing, installing, training, and operating the product, and are defined in the PWS. Work will be accomplished in accordance with Federal Aviation Administration Orders, Air Force Instructions/Manuals and other applicable procedure design publications. Additionally, this requirement is performance-based and all procedures in

DAFI63-138, Acquisition of Services, will be followed to the maximum extent possible. Therefore, this acquisition will be a follow-on contract for the continued performance of a highly specialized service.

MDA, through the Canadian Commercial Corporation, is the original equipment manufacturer (OEM) and is uniquely positioned as the only source with comprehensive knowledge, specialized engineering and technical support, and an established history of maintaining GPD software (exclusively since 2001; over 5.5 million lines of code). HQ AFFSA, leading the effort for the DoD, has guided the software's adaptation to meet the evolving needs of the Department of Defense. MDA's proven high performance and ability to rapidly adapt to regulatory updates ensure a highly capable software solution. This software has been a commercial product from its

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inception, with the contract providing both engineering and technical support and directing the modifications necessary to support DoD mission support capability. The ability to incorporate FAA, ICAO and NATO criteria into one product is something no other company is currently capable of. The contract also dictates the requirements for updating the software yearly with over 50 regulations. CCC/MDA retains sole proprietary ownership of the software and maintains exclusive control over its distribution outside the government. HQ AFFSA, as part of the contract, is given 400 floating licenses in perpetuity to be disseminated to the field. The government has challenged and reached an agreement for data/IP rights assertions. The current contract includes an addendum to DFARS 252.227-7014 with Government Purpose Rights agreement between HQ AFFSA and CCC/MDA for a period of ten (10) years through December 2030. In addition, upon expiration of the five-year or other negotiated period, the government shall have unlimited rights in the computer software or computer software documentation. However, providing the computer software or computer software documentation would not allow other companies to maintain, update, and accredit the software in a rapidly evolving operational environment, as MDA does today and as required on this contract to fulfill the government's requirements. With these unlimited rights, other companies would be required to undertake a full-scale development effort to build a replacement capability, not just a maintenance takeover. Furthermore, other companies would face immediate obsolescence due to required annual major software releases and several minor software releases throughout the year.

The development of this capability was a joint venture with the FAA, who, at the time, also lacked a solution to address their needs. The FAA later exited the contract when the product no longer met their evolving requirements. Specifically, the Air Force contracted with MDA in 1997 for Air Force Terminal Instrument Procedures - Replacement (AFTERP-R), the predecessor to the current GPD system. While contracting practices accepted the initial agreement, questions have arisen after two decades of successful operation. It's important to understand that proprietary rights, if any, apply only to the specific software version at the time of development, not to the software as a whole or any future updates. Owning rights to an outdated version holds no practical value given the ongoing evolution of the system. GPD undergoes annual updates to incorporate changes in over 50 flying regulations dictated by the FAA, ICAO, and NATO. These changes are essential to ensure the software's usability for the DoD, which relies on it for over 21,000 annual flying missions. GPD has become a critical weapons sustainment system. Prior to GPD, flight procedure evaluation was a manual, inefficient process involving drafting tables, paper maps, and calculators. The impetus for GPD arose following the tragic death of Secretary Ron Brown, which led the SECDEF to mandate that all DoD assets flying into foreign airports require safety evaluations by US TERPs specialists. This policy increased our workload exponentially, underscoring the urgent need for an automated solution like GPD.

In 2001, the Air Force awarded a contract to MDA through CCC (F19628-01-C-0012) to replace its limited, self-developed program, AFTERPs. AFTERPs was the Air Force's first attempt to use technology for instrument procedure design, which was traditionally done by hand. However, it lacked key features like departure design and air traffic control chart capabilities, and it didn't warn users about violating design rules. HQ AFFSA partnered with the FAA to create a better solution. They required robust software that could design instrument procedures, alert users to design violations, and be updated yearly. MDA won the contract and created "AFTERPS-R," the predecessor to GPD, providing software and technical support. The Air Force allowed MDA to retain the data rights to AFTERPS-R, which is the predecessor to the commercial GPD software. The commerciality of the GPD software has benefited the government by enabling the Air Force to receive updates as part of the license versus paying separately for updates, improvements, and features like Simultaneous Independent Parallel Instrument Approach (SIPIA) and Standard Terminal Arrival Routes (STARs) capabilities. This added capability has enabled the DoD to develop STARs procedures instead of relying on the FAA.

Previously, the DoD had to rely on the FAA to develop STARs procedures, but now they can do it themselves. If the DoD owned the software, they would only receive improvements they paid for. With the current arrangement, they get all updates and improvements at no additional cost.

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HQ AFFSA has determined that award to any other source would result in (1) substantial duplication of cost to the government that is not expected to be recovered through competition, and (2) unacceptable delays in fulfilling the Air Force's requirement that would lead to mission failure. Awarding this contract to anyone other than MDA would be significantly detrimental to the Air Force for the following reasons:

1. Substantial Duplication of Costs: The Air Force would lose the critical capability embedded in the current GPD software and incur significant, unrecoverable costs to develop a replacement. An analysis conducted by the HQ AFFSA TERPS (Terminal Instrument Procedures) section, based on extensive market research, concluded that abandoning the proprietary GPD software would trigger two major cost categories:

- Parallel Contract Costs: During the multi-year transition to a new system, the Air Force would be forced to continue funding the existing MDA contract to ensure safety and operational continuity. Simultaneously, it would have to execute and fund a new contract for the development and testing of a replacement system. This overlap would effectively double testing efforts, man-hours, and funding. Given the highly specialized nature of this field, costs for a new contract are expected to be comparable to the current effort, resulting in a duplication of costs estimated at [REDACTED] per year throughout the transition.
- Total Replacement Costs: To fully abandon MDA's software, the DoD would be required to redevelop, flight check, and certify all 11,000+ existing flight procedures using the new software. The analysis performed by the HQ AFFSA TERPS section, which is responsible for this process, estimates that the development, coordination, quality assurance, environmental analysis, and flight inspection for a single procedure requires approximately 227 man-hours at a cost of [REDACTED]. Therefore, the total estimated cost to abandon MDA's software and replicate its capabilities in a new system is approximately [REDACTED]

2. Unacceptable Delays and Mission Failure: The GPD software is on the critical path for the DoD's ability to conduct over 21,000 flying missions annually. A transition to a new contractor would introduce unacceptable delays, culminating in a complete mission stoppage.

- The Critical Path to Failure: FAA and ICAO regulations mandate that the procedure design software be updated to comply with published changes within two years. If the software is not updated within this timeframe, it becomes obsolete and cannot be safely used for procedure development or evaluation. This is a full-stop failure point. Without compliant software, the DoD's ability to safely fly and create instrument procedures ceases to exist. As stated by the program manager, failing to maintain this capability is a way to "shut down the DoD."
- Replacement Timeline: It would take a new contractor a minimum of two years to develop comparable software. Following development, the DoD anticipates an additional three to five years to field the system. This extended fielding timeline is primarily driven by the FAA's limited capacity to perform the 11,000+ individual flight inspection flights required to certify every procedure converted to the new software.
- Mission Impact: This results in a total lead time of five to seven years to field a competitive system. During this period, the DoD's ability to respond to new mission requirements and ensure the safety of existing procedures would be severely degraded. Ultimately, once the existing software becomes non-compliant with regulations, the DoD's aviation missions that rely on these procedures would grind to a halt, forcing a revert to outdated and potentially unsafe paper-based methods.

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Switching contractors would be too costly, time-consuming, and would introduce catastrophic risk to the Air Force's mission. The current GPD software is the only system that meets the complex needs of the DoD. Accordingly, MDA is the only firm capable of providing the GPD software and associated services described in Section III without the U.S. Air Force experiencing substantial duplication of costs and unacceptable, mission-ending delays.

V. Description of efforts made to ensure that offers are solicited from as many potential sources as practicable, including whether a notice was or will be publicized as required by subpart 5.2 and, if not, which exception under FAR 5.202 applies.

Sources Sought Synopsis (SSS) was published on SAM.gov, dated 15 August 2025, to determine if other software is available as a replacement that provides the required capabilities. One (1) response was received: the incumbent, MDA.

This requirement will be synopsized in <https://sam.gov> as a notice of proposed contract action IAW FAR 5.101. March 2026 is expected date of publication.

VI. Determination by the Contracting Officer that the anticipated cost to the Government will be fair and reasonable.

The Contracting Officer will ensure that the items described herein are negotiated at a fair and reasonable price to the government. IAW FAR as supplemented, the contractor will be required to submit Other Than Certified Cost or Pricing Data. A detailed price analysis will be performed. The Contracting Officer may request a technical evaluation from the Defense Contract Management Agency (DCMA) or program office subject matter experts to aid in the evaluation of the contractor's proposal if necessary. The Contracting Officer will seek audit assistance from the Defense Contract Audit Agency (DCAA) if necessary.

VII. Description of the market research conducted and the results, or a statement of the reasons market research was not conducted.

IAW FAR 10, Market Research began in December 2024 and concluded August 2025. Results revealed GPD is still a highly specialized software product not available from other sources.

Market Research Techniques included Internet searches, vendor outreach (Sources Sought Synopsis (SSS)), subject matter expert (SME) in specific markets, and SAM search. An Internet search of capability for sources that were readily able to provide sustainment and further development of the current instrument flight procedure design software for DoD application yielded no sources. Websites checked included:

- 1) www.google.com
- 2) www.gsaglobalsupply.gov
- 3) www.gsaadvantage.gov
- 4) www.business.com
- 5) www.marketresearch.com

An effort to seek additional sources was made, where three (3) industry vendors were engaged. While vendors could possess partial requirements capabilities, all fell short of meeting full USAF and DoD need

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and requirement. The existing commercial softwares (FPDAM, TARGETS, Final Approach, and GeoTitan) do not support all the procedure types, and associated criteria that are required for use by the DoD. No vendor would support TERPS (FAA) criteria, ICAO criteria, NATO criteria, and DoD criteria (as listed in Streamlined Market Research and Acquisition Approach).

A Sources Sought Synopsis was posted on SAM.gov on 15 August 2025 labeled AFFSA_Software_Solution to determine if other software is available that can provide the required capabilities. One (1) complete response was received: the incumbent, MDA.

This follow-on contract is considered commercial in nature as the software and support the government is acquiring is available and sold in the commercial marketplace to non-government agencies. GPD expertise and domain knowledge is essential to maintaining the quality of the software and the timeliness of delivery of required modifications. MDA is the only known source that can satisfy the agency's requirements.

VIII. Any other facts supporting the use of Other Than Full and Open Competition.

No further information

IX. List of any sources that expressed, in writing, an interest in the acquisition.

No further information.

X. A statement of the actions, if any, the agency may take to remove or overcome any barriers to competition before any subsequent acquisitions for the supplies or services required.

As a result of MDA being the only source able to support GPD and it's tailored specific to meet Air Force needs, as well as duplication of cost and unacceptable delay of developing additional sources per Section IV, there are no known additional actions which can be taken to remove barriers to competition. Therefore, specific actions and milestones cannot be established.

No actions to develop future competition will be feasible during the period of performance of this acquisition. GPD has been tailored and made specifically to meet USAF needs. GPD relies on proprietary software and interface protocols owned exclusively by MDA Systems, Ltd. Developing a new competitive software would be technically challenging, time- consuming, and potentially infringe on the incumbent's intellectual proprietary rights. The estimated cost of competing, developing, and training would be disproportionate to the value of this follow-on contract. Moreover, an attempt to develop and customize new software would likely delay critical USAF missions worldwide, be cost prohibitive, and become non- compliant with the USAF network requirements and currency with commercial off-the-shelf (COTS) software utilized within the system. It is not anticipated that an acceptable replacement for GPD will be realized during the performance/ordering period, to include the 5-year ordering period and potential option to extend (up to 6 months).

Per DFARS PGI 206.104-72(b)- As indicated by signature on the Coordination and Approval Document, the previous J&A has been reviewed, and the Approval Authority determines that all stated actions to remove barriers to competition have been accomplished.

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XI. Certification by the Contracting Officer.

As evidenced by my signature above, I certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

XII. Certification by the technical/requirements personnel.

As evidenced by my signature above, I certify that any supporting data contained herein, which is my (our) responsibility, is both accurate and complete.